

IMPACTFUL AUDIO AND ANC

The H1 chip offers a stable and efficient listening experience. But, again, no high-fidelity codecs like LDAC or aptX here. It supports only AAC (HD) and SBC codecs.

As for the sound profile, Powerbeats Fit is energetic with boosted bass output, forward but thin vocals and guitar sounds, and a recessed and not very airy high.

Kick drums in Dream Theatre's Pull Me Under, and bass drops in Billie Eilish's Bad Guy hit with weight. Bass feels big but not deep. Still, EDM, pop, and hip-hop feel lively and fun. Vocals sound clear, for instance, Johnny Cash's voice in Hurt, but it lacks the warmth and personal feel. Certain vocals and acoustic instruments can sound harsh.

So, while it is impactful and entertaining, it is not for everyone and certainly not for purists. They are great for workouts, bass-driven playlists, and podcasts.

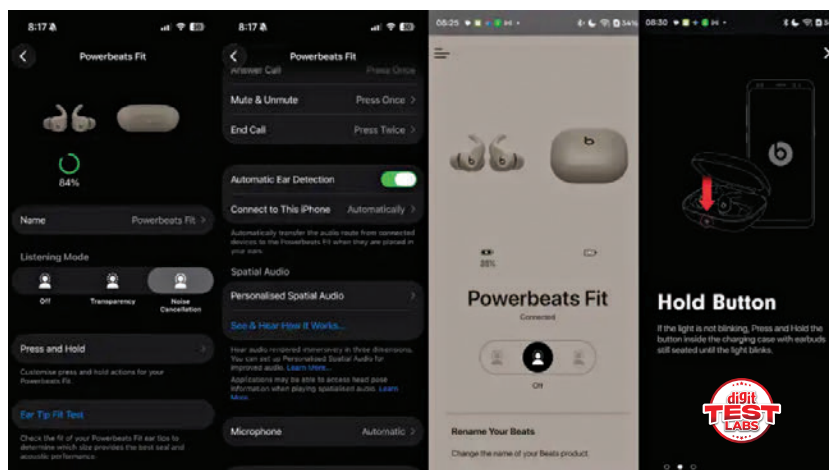
Compared to AirPods Pro, the Beats feel more aggressive and less refined. And compared to the Sony LinkBuds Fit, the Beats seal better, so the sense of punch and immersion is stronger, but Sony still sounds more relaxed.

Like AirPods, there is Personalised Spatial Audio here, which works with Apple devices only and is fun to use with Apple TV+ and compatible tracks.

ANC is great, but sharp noises like keyboard sound, movement of office chair wheels, etc, still break through. Its ANC is easier on the ears compared to the LinkBuds Fit. And since its design offers a good seal, there is good passive isolation too. Transparency Mode also works well and is useful for ambient awareness. So, the overall listening experience stays practical for daily outdoor commuting and activities.

LASTING ENDURANCE

Battery life is one area where Beats has tuned this just right for active use. I was getting close to 13 hours at 60% volume and 8 hours with 80% volume. In both cases, ANC was on, and I was listening



with the AAC codec. Furthermore, the case is said to ideally take the total to roughly 30 hours.

In real-world terms, I charged once mid-week and forgot about it. A 5-minute fast charge gives around an hour of playback, which genuinely saves workouts. And for fully charging the thing, it could take around 20 minutes. Charging is via USB-C. Wireless charging would have made a lot of sense at this price, but it isn't here.

While its competitor from Sony also doesn't have wireless charging, the Beats earbuds offer more runtime and quicker charging than the competition.

VERDICT

Beats positions the Powerbeats Fit as earbuds for people who like to move. In daily use, that pitch holds up. The wingtip design keeps them in place and helps create a secure seal for passive isolation. With decent ANC, they let you focus on what you are doing, whether that is work or a workout. The physical buttons make it easy to control noise, calls, and music. And the tuning leans toward bass, which works well for punchy, motivational tracks you might use while training.

But they are not the lightest earbuds, and you may start to feel them after long sessions. The sound signature will not suit everyone. There is no EQ to adjust it either. Compared to its rival, the Sony LinkBuds Fit, the Beats app only

covers the basics, and there is also no support for higher-resolution Bluetooth codecs. And compared to its cousin, the AirPods Pro 3, the Powerbeats Fit miss out on newer processing, stronger ANC and transparency, heart-rate tracking, live translation, wireless charging, and better IP57 protection.

Even with these trade-offs, the Powerbeats Fit still make sense if you train often, want earbuds that stay secure, and prefer a lively, energetic sound. They work with both Android and iOS, and if you use an iPhone, the setup and connection feel simple. The Powerbeats Fit don't try to be everything. They try to be secure, comfortable enough, good-sounding, and straightforward. And in that very specific lane, they work.

—G. S. Vasan

SPECIFICATIONS

Chip: Apple H1 Headphone Chip | Form factor: In-ear with universal secure-fit wingtips | Buds Battery Life: 6 hrs with ANC | Battery life with case: 30 Hrs | IP Rating: IPX4 | Noise Cancellation: ANC with transparency mode | Connectivity: Bluetooth | Charging: USB C | Audio: Personalized Spatial Audio with dynamic head tracking

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